

EVAN ORTICIO

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Employment

Colorado College Assistant Professor, Department of Psychology	2026 - present
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Education

University of California, Berkeley PhD, Developmental Psychology Dissertation Committee: Celeste Kidd (chair), Arianne Eason, Jan Engelmann, Bill Thompson	2020 - 2026
Swarthmore College BA, Psychology and Linguistics, with High Honors	2016 - 2020 GPA: 3.98

Additional Training

Max Planck Institute for Human Development Summer Institute on Bounded Rationality: Decision Making in a Digital World	2025
Central European University Summer School, The Human Mind and the Open Society	2024
Harvard University Harvard Laboratory for Developmental Studies Summer Internship	2019

Publications and Refereed Conference Proceedings

◇ denotes student mentee; * denotes joint authorship

*Shepherd, S., ***Orticio, E.**, ◇Castañeda Barba, M., & Kidd, C. (2026). The brain rot effect: The case for adaptive attentional bandwidth. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Orticio, E., ◇Gao, S., & Kidd, C. (2025). Children learn the meaning of ambiguous evidence from third-party belief revision. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Orticio, E., ◇Meyer, M., & Kidd, C. (2024). Exposure to detectable inaccuracies makes children more diligent fact-checkers of novel claims. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 8, 2322-2329. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-024-01992-8>

Orticio, E., & Kidd, C. (2024). Shifting your opinion makes you change your factual beliefs without evidence. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Orticio, E., ◇Meyer, M., & Kidd, C. (2023). Children flexibly adapt their evidentiary standards to their informational environment. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Orticio, E., Martí, L., & Kidd, C. (2022). Social prevalence is rationally integrated in belief updating. *Open Mind*, 6, 77-87. https://doi.org/10.1162/opmi_a_00056

Orticio, E., Martí, L., & Kidd, C. (2021). Beliefs are most swayed by social prevalence under uncertainty. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Orticio, E. & Christie, S. (2020). Object bias disrupts rule-based generalization in adults across domains. *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society*.

Select Media Coverage & Science Communication

Even four-year-olds instinctively fact-check for misinformation. *Scientific American*.

Kids see a lot more misinformation than we think. *Scientific American: Science of Parenting*.

To make children better fact-checkers, expose them to more misinformation – with oversight. *Berkeley News*.

Like it or not, were prone to adopt popular beliefs, even fake ones. *Berkeley News*.

Fellowships, Honors & Awards

2025	Berkeley Economy & Society Initiative Technology Collaborative Grant — with Sarah Stolp Shepherd, Huiwen Alex Yang & Celeste Kidd (\$2500)
2025	Greater Good Science Center Fellowship (\$6400)
2025	UC Berkeley Psychology Travel Grant (\$800)
2025	UC Berkeley SURF Fellowship — Mentee: Elisa Matalon (\$5000)
2024	UC Berkeley Psychology Departmental Fellowship (\$18,750)
2024	UC Berkeley Graduate Division Conference Travel Grant (\$1500)
2024	UC Berkeley SURF Fellowship — Mentee: Eleanor Gao (\$5000)
2023	Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award, UC Berkeley (\$250)
2023	CogSci Student Travel Grant (\$1200)
2023	UC Berkeley Graduate Division Conference Travel Grant (\$1500)
2022	Berkeley Center for New Media Faculty Seed Grant — PI: Celeste Kidd (\$1950)
2020	Lockwood Memorial Fellowship (\$7500)
2020	Phi Beta Kappa Honor Society, Swarthmore College
2019	Harvard Lab for Developmental Studies Summer Fellowship (\$2000)
2019	Lenfest Student Fellowship (\$3000)
2018	Swarthmore College Summer Research Fellowship (\$3000)
2016	Class of 1964 Scholarship, Swarthmore College
2015	National Merit Scholar

Invited Talks

2025 Stanford University, Causality and Cognition Lab
2024 University of Maryland, Cognition and Development Lab
2023 Berkeley Center for New Media

Conference Presentations

*Shepherd, S., ***Orticio, E.**, ◇Castañeda Barba, M., & Kidd, C. (2026). The brain rot effect: The case for adaptive attentional bandwidth. *Poster presented at CogSci.*

Orticio, E., ◇Gao, S., & Kidd, C. (2025). Children learn the meaning of ambiguous evidence from third-party belief revision. *Poster presented at CogSci.*

Orticio, E., ◇Meyer, M., & Kidd, C. (2025). Exposure to detectable inaccuracies makes children more diligent fact-checkers of novel claims. *Poster presented at Max Planck Institute for Human Development Summer Institute.*

Orticio, E. & Kidd, C. (2024). Shifting your opinion makes you change your factual beliefs without evidence. *Poster presented at CogSci.*

Guley, O., Handley-Miner, I., **Orticio, E.** & Sommer, J. (2024). Can awareness of issue complexity facilitate open dialogue? *Talk presented at The Human Mind and the Open Society Summer School, Central European University.*

Orticio, E., ◇Meyer, M., & Kidd, C. (2024). Exposing kids to detectable inaccuracies makes them more diligent fact-checkers of novel claims. *Poster presented at Misinformation & Belief Science Preconference, SPSP.*

Orticio, E., ◇Meyer, M., & Kidd, C. (2023). Children flexibly adapt their evidentiary standards to their informational environment. *Talk presented at CogSci.*

Orticio, E., ◇Meyer, M., & Kidd, C. (2023). Children increase their evidentiary standards in more unreliable informational environments. *Talk presented at Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development.* Co-organizer of preconference workshop.

Orticio, E., Martí, L., & Kidd, C. (2021). Beliefs are most swayed by social prevalence under uncertainty. *Poster presented at CogSci.*

Orticio, E. & Christie, S. (2020). Object bias disrupts rule-based generalization in adults across domains. *Talk presented at CogSci.*

Teaching

University of California, Berkeley

Spring 2026	PSYCH 205: Data Analysis (Steven Piantadosi) <i>Graduate Student Instructor, 1 section (23 students). Student rating 7/7.</i>
Fall 2025	PSYCH 140: Developmental Psychology (Jan Engelmann) <i>Graduate Student Instructor, 3 sections (70 students). Student rating 6.8/7.</i> <i>Invited guest lecture, The Development of Belief Formation</i>
Spring 2024	PSYCH 140: Developmental Psychology (Fei Xu) <i>Graduate Student Instructor, 3 sections (65 students). Student rating 6.8/7.</i>
Fall 2023	PSYCH 298: Quantitative Analysis and Coding Knowledge (QuACK) <i>Co-instructor, Student-led R workshop for incoming PhD students</i>
Spring 2023	PSYCH 147: Methods in Cognitive Development (Celeste Kidd) <i>Invited guest lecture, Are children skeptical?</i>
Spring 2022	PSYCH 147: Methods in Cognitive Development (Celeste Kidd) <i>Graduate Student Instructor, 3 sections (69 students). Student rating 6.7/7.</i>

Swarthmore College

Fall 2019	PSYC 025: Research Design and Analysis
Spring 2017	CPSC 021: Introduction to Computer Science

Mentorship

Undergraduate Theses	Elisa Matalon (Cognitive Science) Shihan Eleanor Gao (Highest Honors, Psychology)
Undergraduate Researchers	Yasmine Caraiscos Malia Orwig Jeannie Eom Jasmine Ibrahim Javier Lopez Angela Zhang Gracie Ventre Laila Nahas Sherry Huang Leah Abazari Nia Elrick Emily Nightingale CiCi Jiang Jolie Witkowski
Postbac Researchers	Swetha Srikari Maganti Kara Medina Lauryn Shipp Martin Meyer
Other Mentorship Activity	Getting into Graduate School Program, UC Berkeley Project SHORT

Service

Departmental Service, UC Berkeley

2025-2026	Mentor, Research Experience Pathways in Psychology
2025	Panelist, Teaching Psychology for First-Time Instructors
2023-2024	Member, Faculty-Graduate Student Committee
2023	Student Representative, Cognition Faculty Search
2021-2022	Member, Diversity, Equity & Inclusion Committee

Professional Service

Reviewer	Cognition, Memory & Cognition, Cognitive Science Society Conference
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